Chapter 12 — Group 12
PROGRAM END

[Instructions: Read this chapter prior to coming to your next group. Make a few notes for yourself before coming to group. ***In group you will stand up and speak for a few moments.***]

In a simple way, this brief program has only taken you to the point of making some decisions and hopefully starting to carry them out. You have the right to change your mind as circumstances and conditions change, but you should try to do what is best for you and those you have relationships with. Take responsibility for yourself first. Seek more help. Coping with relationships is a never-ending process.

It is our hope that you have made some progress and understand relationships better. We also hope that you are a little happier and have less stress. At the same time, we need to caution you that there are people in your group who will see you as a role model. They can get hope, inspiration, and help from you. This chapter, and your final group meeting, represent an opportunity for you to help others while you make commitments to yourself. Take some time and prepare a few notes to yourself about the 6 issues listed below. In group, you will be asked to stand up for a few minutes (no more than 15) and address each issue. You may look at your notes as you speak, but you shouldn't just read. Speak to the group from your heart. After you have finished, the facilitator may allow a few questions. You have our best wishes.

The Things Your Talk Must Address

1. What you thought about codependence when you first entered this group.

I didn't know anything. I had a kind of expectation that it was enabling someone to complete their bad behaviro, but that's all I knew from alanon.

2. What codependence means to you now.

Codependence focuses on another's problems more than one's own. It's an unhealthy relationship dynamic that may seem helpful on the surface, but doesn't deal with any real issues in the relationship as much as it covers them over temporarily.

3. What you have learned about your problem relationships.

I have left most of my problem relationships behind. I don't have many right now, and I learned that the work I do to keep them on the right track is where those relationships need to be going, generally.

4. How you feel about yourself now, and how you felt when you first entered.

I feel more comfortable having an awareness of this specific dynamic of unhealthy relationships. Now I question my relationships a bit more, but I still feel good about myself and how things are going.

5. What are some of the things you have accepted as truth about yourself and your relationships.

Myself and my relationships change. Relationships come and go, and we can enjoy the time we have together best if we're honest, compassionate, and supportive.

6. What are the things you really control in your life.

I can control my decision making. I can use that to prevent many situations. When I'm in a situation, I can choose how I act in that situation. I can't control how other people will act, but I can do the best I can for myself.